It needed a war like the present one to expose to the world the fact that the mighty British Lion was not in reality as powerful as it appeared to be, but had feet of clay. The Empire owed its birth and continuance to military strength, including sea-power, and prestige. When internal deterioration set in and different parts of the Empire began to strive for their independence, other Western nations were making rapid progress in science, industry, methods of warfare etc. and Great Britain was not able to keep abreast of them. To a keen observer it was quite clear that the ultimate fate of the British Empire was doomed and it only needed an international clash to bring about its speedy down-fall. Till this clash took place in September, 1939, the British Empire was, however, able to maintain its existence and keep up appearances through its past prestige. The series of overwhelming defeats which England has suffered in the different war-fronts since September, 1939, have now not only exposed her actual military position, but also have shattered her prestige throughout the world including the dependencies and colonies of Great Britain. During the course of this note I shall show that with her prestige completely shattered and her actual military position so thoroughly exposed before the world, the British regime in India today is like a house of cards.

According to our view in India, when the collapse of the British Empire comes about, the following developments are likely to take place. Canada, Australia and New Zealand, will gravitate towards the United States of America. Ireland, South Africa, India, Palestine, Egypt, Iraq etc. will throw off the British yoke and attain full-fledged independence. And the African colonies of England will be divided among the other powers. Great Britain will remain as the third class power in Europe, with no influence on the Continent.

It is within the reach of the Axis Powers to bring about the immediate collapse of the British Empire and its complete dismemberment. And it is possible for India to help in this task. It is hardly necessary to add that we in India want to see the complete dis-memberment of this Empire, for we regard it as the greatest curse in modern history.

III. *The importance of India in the British Empire*

India with her vast population and untold natural resources